Art Nouveau



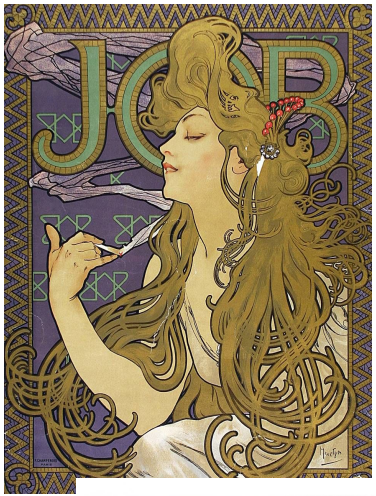
Charles Rennie Mackintosh

1890 - 1910/14



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mXxroeXHQbo

ACTIVITY 1 - Starter: Record your thoughts… **SEE, THINK, WONDER**









"What do you notice about these objects? What are their key visual features?

Record your thoughts… **SEE, THINK, WONDER**

Individually record your observations:

'What do I see?',
'What do I think about this?',
'What does it make me wonder?'.
"Why do you think natural forms were used instead of geometric shapes?
What does 'handmade' look like in a finished product?"

Prompt: organic lines, nature motifs, and craftsmanship,

USEFUL Link:
https://www.vam.ac.uk/articles/the-whiplash#:~:text=The%20decorative%20motif%20that%20has,into%20a%20new%20Modern%20era.

Activity 2: Glasgow Style



"How do these two objects relate to each other?

How are they different?"

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zVdLg5JNjss



Main Information on Arts Nouveau Movement

Art Nouveau's core principles include flowing, asymmetrical lines, the use of natural and organic motifs, and an emphasis on craftsmanship over industrialization, while Charles Rennie Mackintosh adapted these by blending Art Nouveau's decoration with strong geometric forms, the simplicity of Japonisme, Symbolism, and a holistic design approach that integrated architecture, interiors, and furniture into a unified whole.

Art Nouveau Core Principles

Nature and Organic Forms:
Art Nouveau embraced the beauty of the natural world, using organic, flowing, and asymmetrical lines, often described as the "whiplash curve," to capture the forms of plants, flowers, and tendrils.
Emphasis on Craftsmanship:
The movement prioritized hand craftsmanship over mass production, aiming to create unique and artistic products that valued individual artistry and thoughtful design.
Holistic Design:
Art Nouveau promoted the idea of a unified design, where architecture, interior design, furniture, and decorative arts were conceived as part of a single, integrated creation.
Symbolism:
Artists and designers used symbolic motifs, such as floral forms, to imbue their creations with meaning and express artistic ideas.

Charles Rennie Mackintosh's Principles

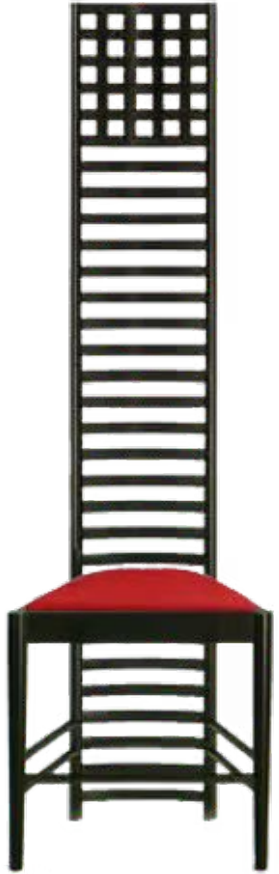
Glasgow Style:
Mackintosh developed his own version of Art Nouveau, known as the Glasgow Style, which combined international Art Nouveau elements with the simplicity and minimalism of Japonisme and the clarity of Modernism.
Geometric Order:
He introduced severe but eccentric geometry, contrasting strong right angles with the flowing lines of naturalistic motifs, creating a distinct balance between order and ornamentation.
Symbolism and Spiritualism:
Mackintosh's work is characterized by inherent symbolism, where his geometric forms and motifs, like the iconic Mackintosh Rose, carried significant meaning, particularly in his windows, which combined geometric abstraction with organic forms.
Integration of Art and Life:
Like Art Nouveau, Mackintosh believed in a holistic approach, designing everything from architecture and interiors to furniture, lighting, and even menus as a unified work of art to create an immersive experience for the individual.
Inspiration from Scotland and Japan:
His designs drew inspiration from his Scottish heritage, the simplicity of Japanese design (Japonisme), and the emerging industrial and Modernist ideas of his time, blending these influences to create a uniquely personal style.

Activity 3: The ‘Hill House’ chair

Analyse the ‘Hill House’ chair as if you were a product design critic. "What design influences do you see? What methods did he use? What judgements can you make about its success as a piece of design?"

- Work individually, using your Chromebooks to research and write a structured analysis of the object. Reference specific Art Nouveau principles and elements of Mackintosh's style in your critique.

- Share your analysis in the group, comparing their independent judgments and refining your arguments through peer feedback.



Assessment/Exit Ticket

As seen in:

Blade Runner The Addams Family Star Trek: The Original Series (TOS)

Designer: Charles Rennie Mackintosh
Director: Ridley Scott





https://filmandfurniture.com/product/argyle-chair-by-charles-rennie-mackintosh/

Assessment/Exit Ticket

"Choose one of Charles Rennie Mackintosh's objects. Write a short paragraph that analyzes its key design features, evaluates its relationship to the broader Art Nouveau movement, and provides a personal judgment on its historical significance. Your analysis should reference at least two specific design methods or influences we discussed today."

Exemplar Response: An exemplar response would clearly identify a specific Mackintosh object, such as the **Argyle Chair,** and accurately describe its key features (e.g., tall, high-backed verticality, geometric lattice-work). It would evaluate its relationship to Art Nouveau by noting its departure from traditional whiplash curves while retaining the movement's focus on unified design and natural forms. The response would conclude with a well-reasoned personal judgment on its significance, perhaps arguing it represents a more modern, restrained evolution of the style that anticipated future design movements.